Reducing the "Crane Waiting for Truck" Operational Stoppage

SIX SIGMA YELLOW BELT PROJECT · SOCIEDAD PORTUARIA CALDERA (SPC)

D M A I C

ALL PHASES COMPLETE

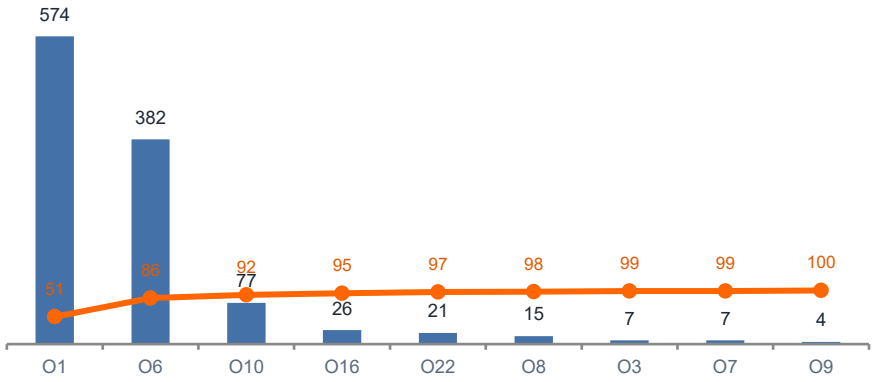
Hanseatic Global Terminals

1 THE CHALLENGE

During 2025, the stoppage **"Crane Waiting for Truck"** accounted for roughly **60% of all operational stoppages under the terminal's direct control** (OEE study), directly capping vessel cargo-transfer speed. With **no systematic way to measure it**, the team set a realistic target: cut crane-wait from **1.8 to 1.4 hours per vessel** (≥20%).

~60%	1.8 h	≥20%
of controllable stoppages (OEE)	baseline crane-wait / vessel	reduction target set

2 THE ANALYSIS



2025 Pareto of operational stoppages. "Crane waiting for truck" (O1) is the #1 driver — **574 events = 51%**; with "Shift change" (O6) it explains **86%**.

DMAIC tools: SIPOC, CTQ, Ishikawa, 5-Whys, Genba MSA, statistical analysis.

3 ACTIONS TAKEN

1. **TOS system query built.** Created the terminal's first systematic data source to extract and quantify the stoppage (IT).
2. **KPI defined & stood up.** Established a measurable crane-wait indicator as the management baseline and provide consistent feedback during the Shift change meetings (Operations).
3. **TT cycles measured per shift.** Quantified terminal-tractor cycles to expose true performance (Equipment & Ground Ops).
4. **Shift-level feedback loop.** Reported performance back to equipment operators & yard controllers every shift.
5. **Genba MSA.** Verified standardized data capture on the ground and confirmed root cause (Storage / Tally chiefs).

Shibumi Link: Decrease the Delay "Crane waiting for trucks"

Sustained by — Cross-functional and functional meetings (Standard Work & Performance Management) / sponsorship (General Management, Operations, BEST & IT) and a continuous habit of communicating measured results back to operational staff.

4 THE RESULTS

1.8 → 1.1 h	+30%	+1,229	USD 332K
Crane-wait per vessel — best month. Target 1.4 h beaten; up to **−39% vs baseline**.	Cargo-transfer capacity gained	Additional container moves / year	Added revenue / yr · **USD 76K EBIT / yr**

PROJECT TEAM



PROJECT LEADERS · OPERATIONS CHIEFS
Grettel Arias · **Mauricio Reyes** · **Christian Sosa**
Storage; Tally & Liquidation; Equipment & Ground Ops

MASTER BLACK BELT / COACH
Rolando Vargas — HGT · BEST Program Global Director

SPONSORS / CHAMPIONS
Ricardo Ospina (GM) · **Mario Jiménez** (Operations Manager)

SUPPORT Tally Supervisor · Equipment Coordinator · IT Lead